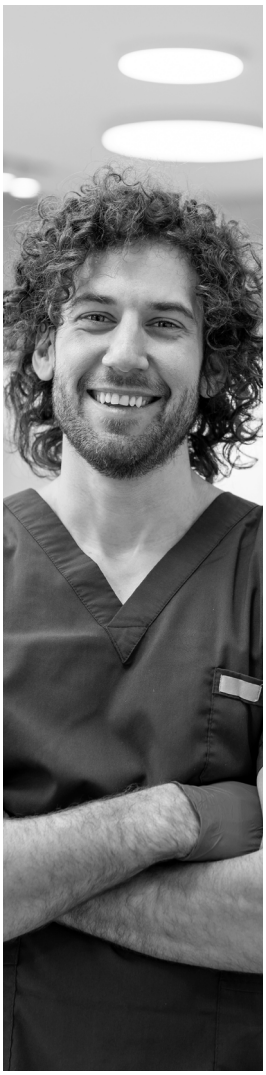
REPEAT PARTICIPANT CHARACTERISTICS ANALYSIS

PY 2025






DEPARTMENT OF
HIGHER EDUCATION &
WORKFORCE DEVELOPMENT

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Evaluation ——— 03

Methodology ——— 04

Performance Outcomes ——— 05

Enrollment Over Time ——— 06

Age Distribution ——— 07

Education Distribution ——— 08

Barriers ——— 09

Training programs Distribution (By CIP Code) ——— 10

Key Takeaways & Actionable Recommendations ——— 12

EVALUATION

Missouri has invested significant time and effort in initiatives designed to provide high quality services to individuals seeking employment and training assistance in Job Centers. These efforts focus on using data and information to continuously strengthen support for customers and improve service delivery.

This report compares two groups of individuals who enrolled in training through WIOA Title I programs: participants who enrolled once (the Single cohort) and participants who enrolled more than once (the Repeat cohort). The analysis reviews participant characteristics, the barriers they report, and outcomes after leaving the program, with particular attention to employment and credential attainment. The purpose is to present clear patterns that staff and partners can use to support stronger program results.

In this report, multiple dimensions are used to compare the Single and Repeat cohorts, including training enrollment rates, age distribution, education levels, reported barriers, and program classifications. These perspectives provide a broad view of how the two groups differ in backgrounds and service needs. The report also offers general insights to help readers better understand these patterns and the factors that may shape participant experiences.

As Missouri strives to improve services delivered through Job Centers, understanding how the customer base has changed over time is essential. Tailoring programs and support to the needs of today's customers can enhance service delivery and expand opportunities for individuals pursuing employment and training goals.






METHODOLOGY

This evaluation includes participants in Workforce Innovation and Opportunity Act (WIOA) Title I Adult, Dislocated Worker, and Youth Programs. All participants were also co-enrolled in the Wagner Peyser Program. This report focuses on individuals who enrolled in at least one training program.

Data used for this analysis is from the Participant Individual Record Layout (PIRL) submitted annually to the United States Department of Labor (DOL) from Program Year (PY) 2018 through PY 2024. Participant counts reflect individuals who exited participation during each program year.

Additional data were gathered from Local Area Unemployment Statistics (LAUS). The analysis uses the unemployment rate at the time each participant exited the program and the county where the participant lived. Unemployment rates were collected by county and by month. The dataset includes Missouri and eight bordering states (Illinois, Arkansas, Iowa, Kansas, Kentucky, Nebraska, Oklahoma, and Tennessee). When a participant lived outside these states, the national unemployment rate was used.

The evaluation uses two primary indicators to assess participant outcomes:

- Employed within a year after exit
- Credential attainment

Analysis across the seven year period is based on annual proportions of individuals in each characteristic category. To examine the relationship between participant characteristics and outcomes, generalized linear mixed models (GLMMs) with a binomial family were employed. These models allow for estimating the likelihood of credential attainment and employment while accounting for both individual-level factors—such as gender, age, education, low-income status, employment entry, and program length—and county level differences through random intercepts. Natural spline terms were used for age and program length to capture potential non-linear effects. This approach supports the identification of consistent patterns across groups and provides evidence to inform service delivery improvements and enhance opportunities for customers working toward employment.

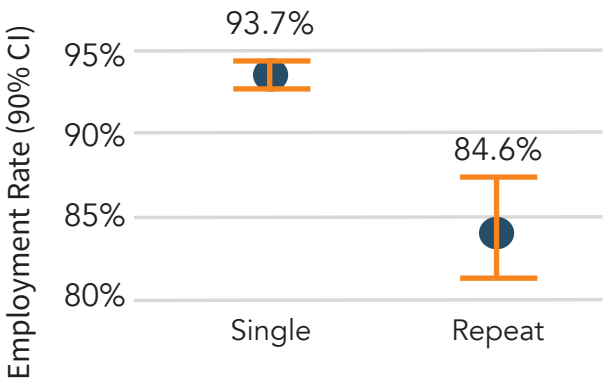




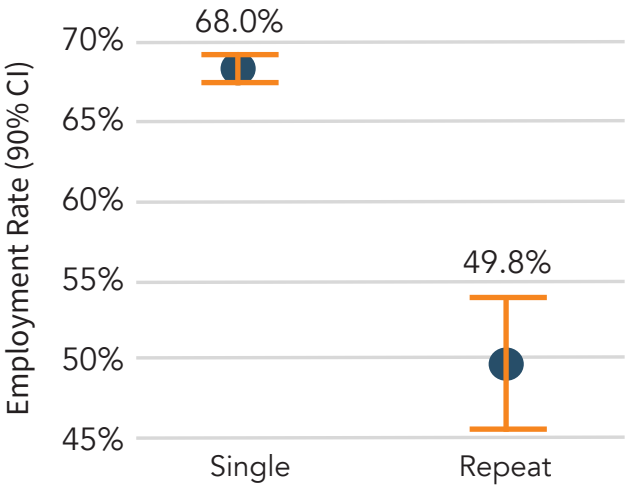

PERFORMANCE OUTCOMES

The WIOA Performance Outcomes graph compares the Single cohort to the Repeat cohort by examining differences between these groups. This comparison helps identify how repeated program engagement relates to employment outcomes, credential attainment, and overall program effectiveness. Since WIOA serves individuals with varied backgrounds and circumstances, identifying outcome patterns supports informed planning and more targeted service delivery.

WIOA Performance: Employed Within a Year



WIOA Performance: Credential



Employment Outcomes

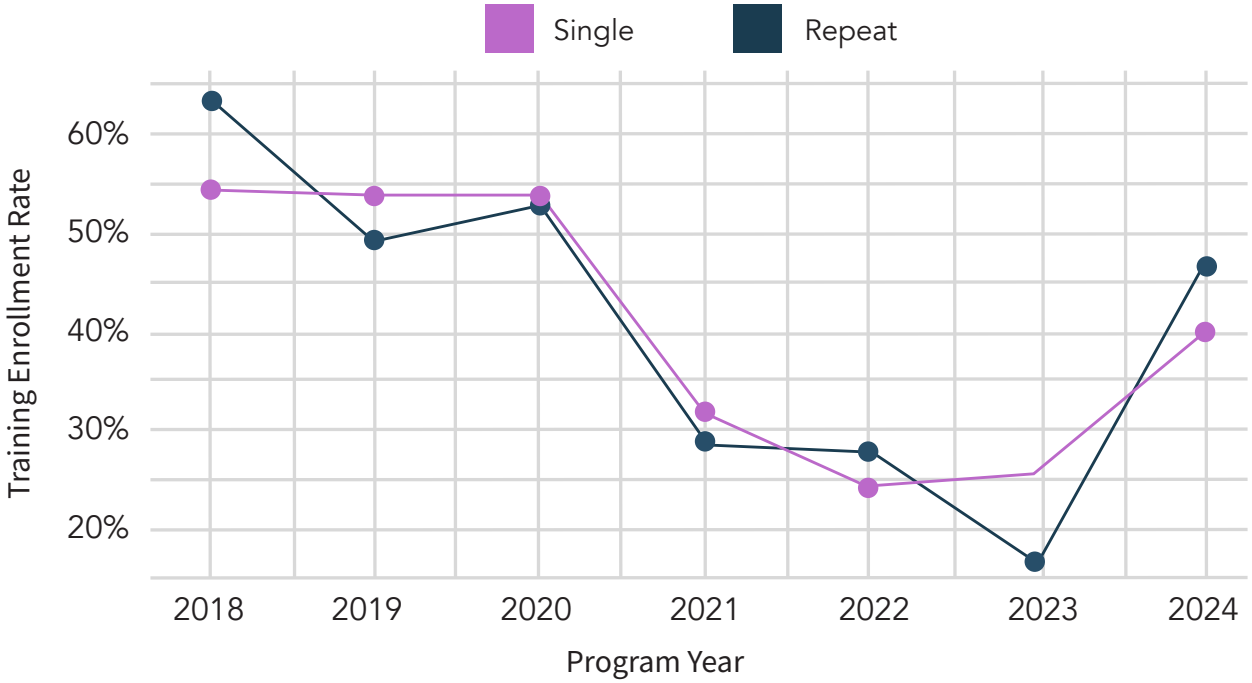
Employment outcomes differ notably between the two groups. An estimated 93.7 percent of Single participants achieved employment after program participation, with a 95 percent confidence interval (CI) ranging from 93.3 percent to 94.1 percent. A CI is a simple way of showing how certain we are about an estimate—it gives a range that the true number is likely to fall within. Among Repeat participants, 84.6 percent achieved employment, with a 95 percent CI of 81.5 percent to 87.4 percent. To ensure accuracy, estimates were generated using validated statistical models and were based on complete administrative records, reducing the likelihood of missing or inconsistent data. These results show that individuals who return to training multiple times tend to have lower employment success than those who complete training in a single enrollment cycle. This gap suggests that the Repeat cohort may face unreported/ unaddressed barriers or require enhanced support to achieve comparable outcomes.

Credential Attainment

Credential attainment also varies across cohorts. Approximately 68.0 percent of Single participants earned a recognized credential (95percent CI: 67.2 percent to 68.8 percent), compared with 49.8 percent of Repeat participants (95 percent CI: 45.7 percent to 53.8 percent). As credential attainment is a key performance measure in WIOA training programs, lower rates among Repeat participants may reflect challenges related to program persistence, academic readiness, or the suitability of selected training pathways. These patterns set the stage for deeper analysis that considers demographic and socioeconomic differences to determine whether the observed disparities reflect participant characteristics, service needs, or true performance differences between enrollment pathways.

ENROLLMENT OVER TIME

Training Enrollment Rate Over Time Single vs. Repeat (PY2018 - PY2024)



WIOA enrollment has shifted across program years, showing periods of increase and decline rather than a consistent upward pattern. These fluctuations reflect how participation in training programs can be influenced by broader labor market conditions, policy changes, and participant needs. While the enrollment levels vary from year to year, the underlying patterns highlight the importance of understanding how external factors shape engagement with WIOA services.

Training Enrollment Rates

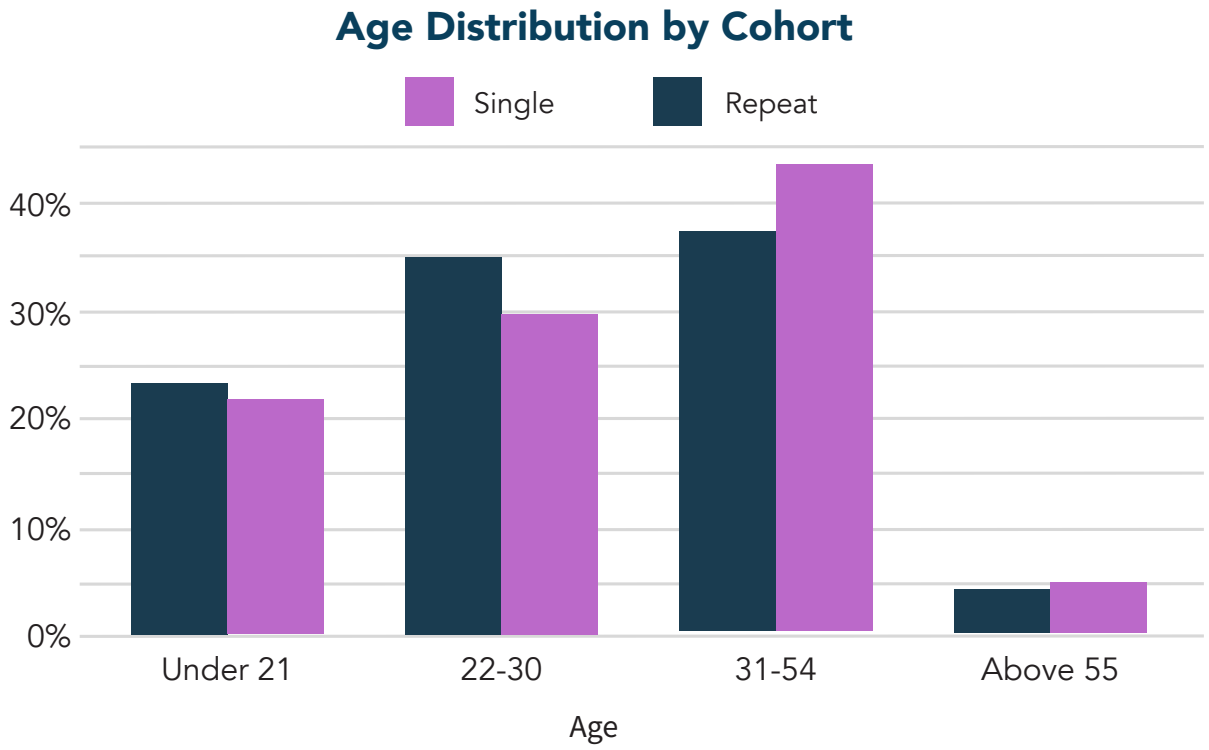
In this report, training enrollment rates represent the share of participants who entered training out of all individuals served each program year. Reviewing these rates over time helps illustrate how the Single and Repeat cohorts participated in training and whether patterns emerged across the eight year period.

Trends and Patterns

The graph shows that training enrollment rates were highest for both the Single and Repeat cohorts in the pre-pandemic period, particularly around PY2018–PY2019. After this point, enrollment rates declined steadily. The decrease is especially noticeable beginning around PY2020 and continuing through PY2023 before showing early signs of stabilizing in PY2024. This pattern suggests a downward shift in the share of participants entering training, although the reasons behind this change cannot be determined from enrollment data alone.

Several factors could contribute to this decline, such as changes in participant's needs or broader economic conditions. When referring to changes in overall participation levels, this analysis focused specifically on the number of individuals in the Single and Repeat cohorts, rather than WIOA participation.

AGE DISTRIBUTION



Age patterns differ between the two cohorts. On average, Repeat participants are younger than Single participants (31.54 years compared with 32.53 years). The Repeat cohort also has a larger share of individuals under age 25, representing 42.6 percent of the group versus 36.7 percent in the Single cohort.

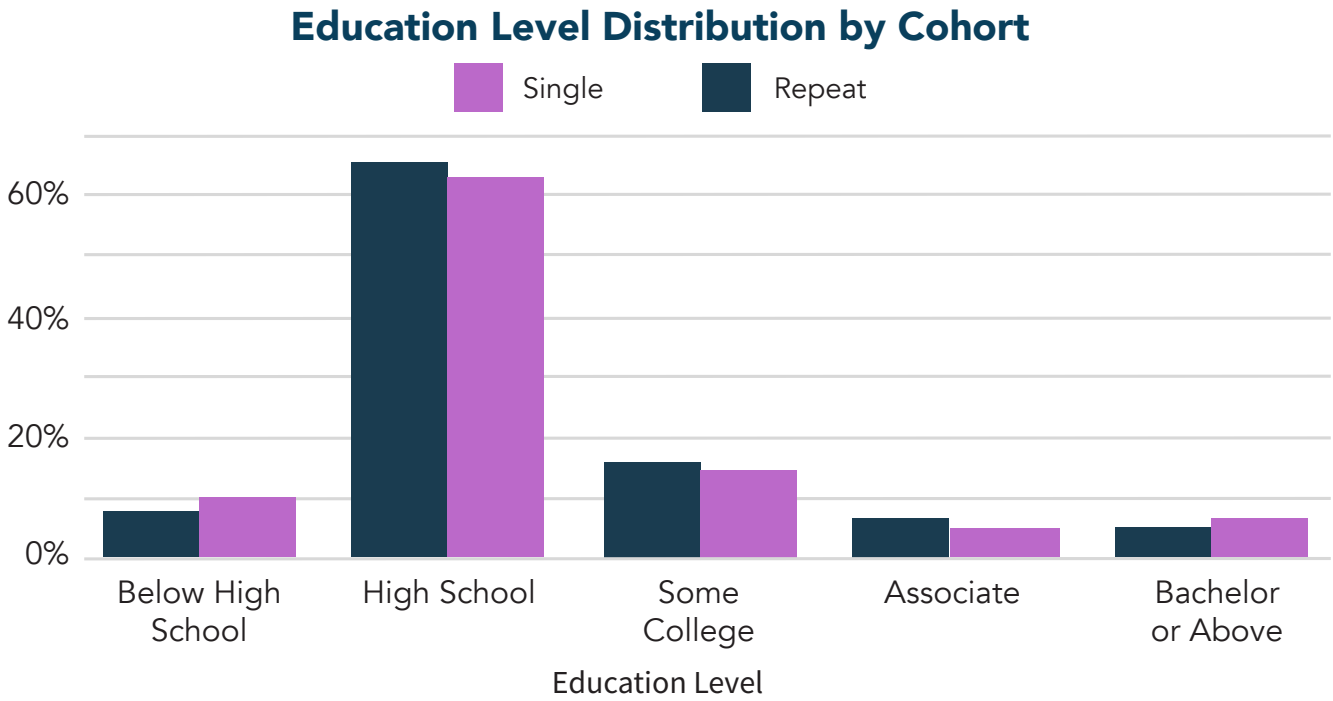
Age Group Patterns

Across broader age bands, Single participants represent a larger share of individuals ages 30 to 54 (43.24 percent) compared with Repeat participants (36.99 percent). In contrast, Repeat participants are more concentrated in the 22 to 30 range (34.92 percent) than Single participants (29.18 percent). Shares for individuals under age 21 are similar, at roughly 22 percent in both groups, and participants aged 55 or older make up a small portion of each cohort. These patterns show that the Repeat cohort skews younger, especially within early career age ranges, while the Single cohort includes a higher proportion of mid-career adults.

Implications

The younger age profile of the Repeat cohort may reflect continued re-engagement among youth and early career workers. This trend has implications for service strategies, including flexible schedules, shorter training modules, and supports tailored to individuals transitioning into the workforce. The larger mid-career share in the Single cohort suggests opportunities to strengthen services related to upskilling or career advancement.

EDUCATION DISTRIBUTION



Education levels are similar across both groups, with High School completion representing the largest share. About 61.9 percent of Single participants and 63.9 percent of Repeat participants fall into this category. The remaining proportions are distributed across Some College (about 15 percent in both groups), Associate degrees (about 5 to 6 percent), Bachelor's degree or higher (6.6 percent for Single and 5.4 percent for Repeat), and Below High School (11.2 percent for Single and 9.1 percent for Repeat). These patterns show that both groups share a similar overall profile, centered on high school completion, with small differences at the lower and higher ends of the education range.

Education Group Patterns

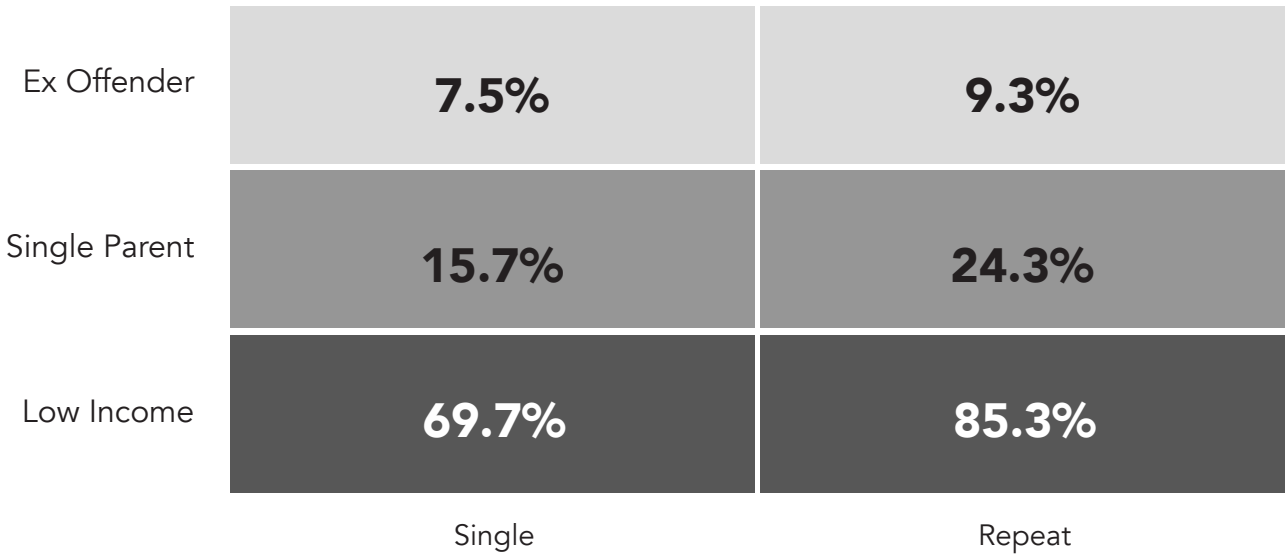
The Repeat cohort contains a slightly higher proportion of participants whose highest education level is High School, as well as modestly higher shares in the Associate degree and Some College categories. In comparison, the Single cohort includes higher proportions of individuals in the Below High School category and the bachelor's degree or above category. Although the distribution varies across specific levels, the overall education profiles of the two groups remain broadly similar.

Implications

For the Repeat cohort, the concentration at the High School level suggests value in strengthening pathways into industry recognized credentials or community college programs, such as short term certificates or options that award credit for prior learning. For the Single cohort, the higher share of participants without a High School diploma points to the continued importance of basic skills instruction, GED/HiSET preparation, and wraparound supports that can improve readiness for training. The presence of Bachelor's level participants also indicates a need for advanced upskilling options, including specialized certifications or training linked to in demand roles.

BARRIERS

Barrier Analysis by Cohort



WIOA collects information on seven potential barriers when participants complete applications: Homelessness, Low Income, English Language Learner, Basic Skills Deficiency, Cultural Barriers, Single Parent status, and Ex Offender status. This evaluation focuses on three of the barriers—Low Income, Single Parent, and Ex Offender—because they are most consistently reported and show the clearest differences between the Single and Repeat cohorts. Rates include individuals with unknown values to provide a complete view of data quality and avoid overstating prevalence.

Barrier Patterns

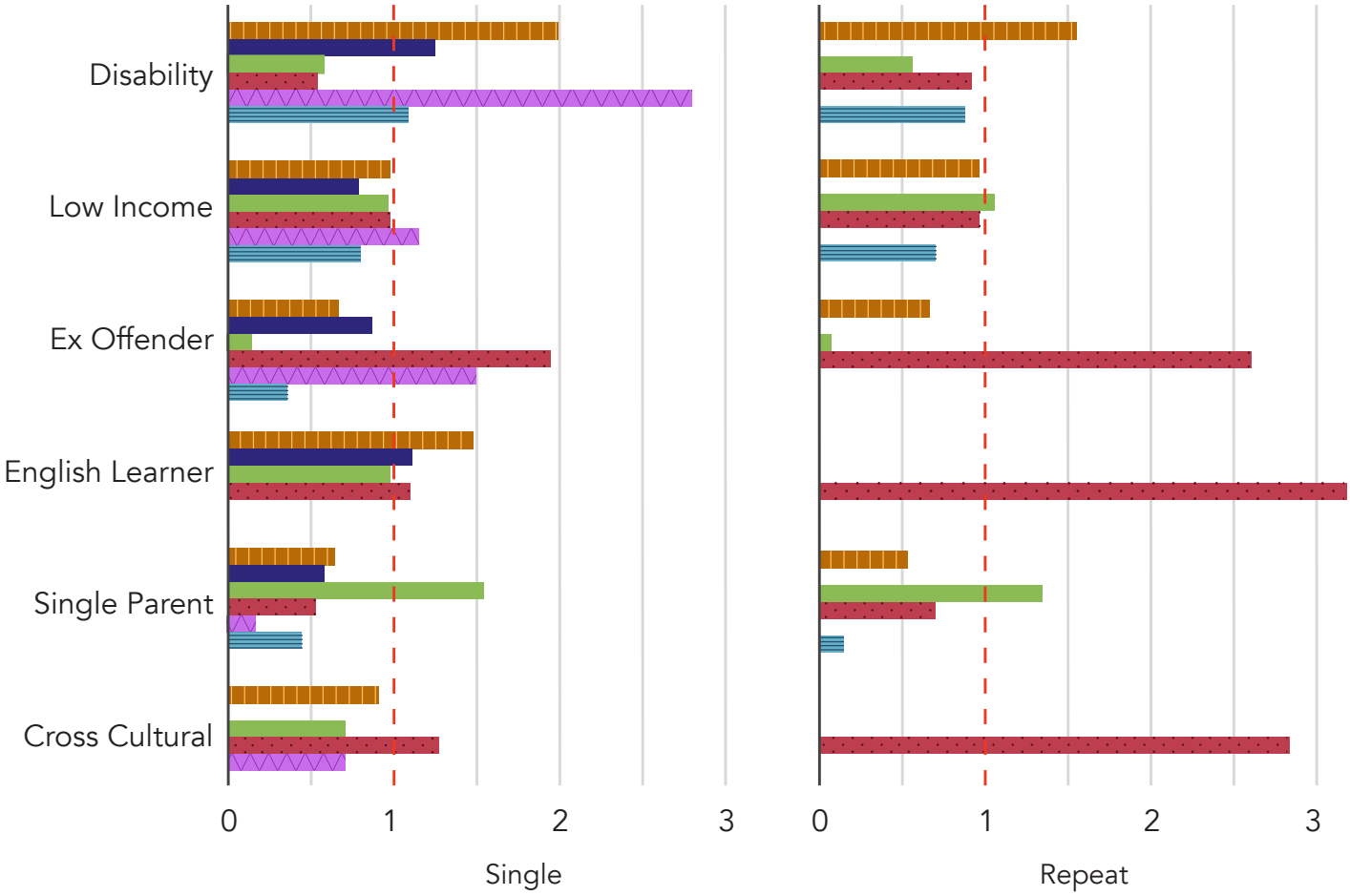
Low Income is the most common barrier for both groups, especially among Repeat participants. About 85.3 percent of Repeat participants fall into this category, compared with 69.7 percent of Single participants. Single Parent is the second most common barrier, with 24.3 percent of Repeat participants and 15.7 percent of Single participants reporting this barrier. Ex Offender status appears less often overall—9.3 percent for Repeat participants and 7.5 percent for Single participants—but is still more common within the Repeat cohort. These patterns suggest that Repeat participants face a more concentrated set of financial and family related challenges, as well as somewhat higher re-entry needs.

Implications

These patterns have several implications for service planning. The high prevalence of Low Income among Repeat participants highlights the need for strong financial stabilization supports, including transportation assistance and short term emergency aid. The higher share of Single Parents suggests opportunities to expand childcare solutions and offer more flexible training schedules. The elevated Ex Offender rate points to the continued importance of targeted re-entry supports for justice involved individuals. Tracking unknown values and reviewing barrier differences by cohort can help identify gaps in data capture and support more effective service delivery.

TRAINING PROGRAMS DISTRIBUTION (BY CIP CODE)

Training Programs vs. Barriers



Instruction:
=1: The same rate as overall population.
>1, Over-represented compared to the overall population. <1, Under-represented compared to the overall population.
Example: In the Single group, the bar for Disability under CIP 48 (Precision Production) extends well to the right of the red line, it indicates CIP 48 attracts or serves a disproportionately higher share of students with disabilities compared to the systemwide rate.

- 11-Computer & Information Sciences & Support Services
- 48-Precision Production
- 49-Transportation & Materials Moving
- 51-Health Professions & Related Clinical Sciences
- 52-Business, Management, Marketing, and Related Support Services
- Other

This graph illustrates how participant reported barriers vary across instructional program clusters, using Classification of Instructional Programs (CIP) codes to organize training areas. The analysis compares the share of each barrier within a CIP group to that barrier's overall rate, highlighting where certain characteristics appear more or less frequently. Customers select programs based on personal interest and career goals while local workforce boards approve programs aligned with local in demand occupations. Differences in enrollments across CIP groups may reflect patterns in both participant choice and the types of occupations associated with each training program.

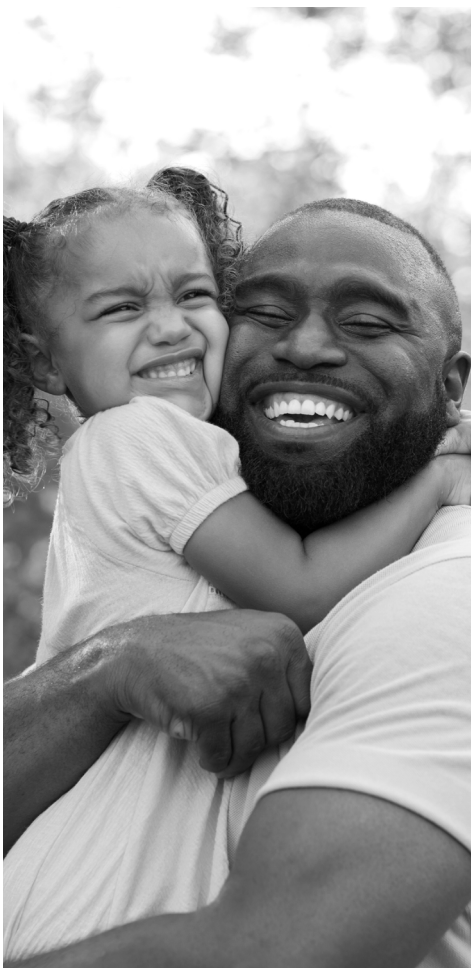
Patterns Across CIP Clusters

Several program areas show higher concentrations of specific barriers. For example, CIP 48 (Precision Production) and CIP 49 (Transportation and Materials Moving) have higher rates of Disability, Ex Offender status, and English Learner status compared with statewide averages. In contrast, CIP 11 (Computer and Information Sciences) shows substantially lower prevalence of these barriers. These differences align with the types of occupations represented within each program area, as well as the characteristics of individuals who typically pursue training in those fields.

Within individual CIP groups, Repeat participants often show higher barrier rates than Single participants. For instance, in CIP 49, Repeat participants have higher levels of reported reentry related barriers and language support needs. Similar differences appear in CIP 51 (Health Professions) and other service related fields, where Single Parent status and Disability are more common among Repeat participants. These patterns show that the concentration of barriers varies both by program type and by whether individuals return for multiple training enrollments.

Implications

Differences in barrier distribution across CIP groups highlight opportunities to tailor support based on the needs commonly associated with each program area. For example, CIP 48 and CIP 49 may benefit from strong connections to disability resources, reentry supports, English language services, and community based partners that specialize in assisting job seekers facing similar barriers. In CIP 51, support related to childcare, family resource navigation, and flexible training options may help address the higher incidence of Single Parent and Disability barriers. Programs such as CIP 11, which show lower barrier levels, may require fewer intensive supports. Across all CIP areas, Repeat participants may benefit from enhanced advising and case management due to consistently higher levels of reported barriers.



KEY TAKEAWAYS & ACTIONABLE RECOMMENDATIONS

The analysis across enrollment trends, participant characteristics, barriers, and training program patterns reveals several consistent themes that can guide program improvement.

- Repeat participants are younger on average. Repeat participants are more concentrated in the 22–30 age range, while Single participants have more mid career adults ages 30–54. These patterns suggest that younger individuals are more likely to return to Job Centers for additional training.

- Education profiles are similar across cohorts, with High School completion being the most common level. The Repeat cohort shows slightly higher shares in High School and Some College categories, while the Single cohort includes more individuals both below and above that range. These differences are modest but help refine service strategies.

- Low Income is the most common barrier in both groups and is especially high among Repeat participants. Single Parent and Ex Offender statuses also appear more often among Repeat participants, indicating more complex economic, family, and reentry needs.

- Strengthen Support for Repeat Participants: Expand targeted case management, transportation and financial assistance, and reentry supports to address the higher concentration of barriers and improve overall outcomes

- Adjust Training Capacity Based on Enrollment Shifts: Monitor participation changes and adapt scheduling, staffing, and outreach to ensure training opportunities match evolving demand across program years.

- Tailor Services to younger Repeat Participants: Increase flexible scheduling options, short term training modules, and career transition supports to meet the needs of younger individuals returning for additional training.

- Strengthen Foundational Skills and Upskilling Pathways: Expand bridge programming, literacy and basic skills supports, and postsecondary transition pathways. Maintain advanced upskilling options for participants with higher levels of education.

Understanding how participant needs change over time is essential for delivering effective services in Missouri's Job Centers. The data and information may be applied to strengthen support strategies and improve employment and training outcomes. The insights gained from this analysis will help guide continuous improvement and ensure services remain responsive to the needs of individuals pursuing employment and training goals.






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